

Developing a "Skills" Section for a Skills Resume

"Skills" resumes are great for job candidates who don't have a lot of experience working in their field yet, who have a history of working in jobs unrelated to their major, or who have employment gaps. These resumes emphasize the skills you have acquired in other areas of your life besides your work, such as volunteer experience and coursework.

The trick with developing a skills resume is to identify **at least three general skills** that you have acquired; naturally, those skills must connect closely with the skills mentioned (or implied) in the posting's Responsibilities and Qualifications sections.

Once you have identified the three general skills, look for **at least three examples of each skill** from your work, school, or volunteer history. Use the content you developed in the Response to Qualifications assignment. And make these examples as **concrete and specific** as you can; these bullet points are the **evidence** readers are looking for to prove you have the skills you list. Readers remember concrete details.

The skills section below was taken from a resume targeting an entry-level marketing job. Note how the writer has tried to list specific examples under each main skill.

Relevant Marketing Skills

Social Media Marketing

- Doubled website visits by creating social media accounts for two businesses and engaging online audiences
- Raised search placement 20% by updating the Score Shoes website and applying SEO strategies
- Posted content on Facebook and Twitter while managing SDSU LGBT Student Association accounts; expanded online engagement by 18%

Team Leadership

- Earned second place nationally by leading a GoTo branding project team and directing competition work
- Secured a City Council LGBT Student Day Proclamation by organizing a SDSU marketing campaign and promoting student outreach
- Completed three rebranding projects by working in SDSU project teams and developing brand strategies

Communication

- Provided writing support by tutoring hundreds of Business Communication students and earned Outstanding Writing Center Tutor
- Delivered two client campaigns by developing marketing plans in MKTG 479 and presenting them for client use
- Produced a monthly newsletter by writing congregation updates and designing each issue